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Measuring misery in ‘wet-bulb temperatures’

As heat is set to invade, doctors point to index as way to gauge true effects

By **Allyson Chiu**
GLOBE STAFF
and **Chris Gloninger**
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Soaring temperatures are expected to bake much of New England starting Wednesday. To avoid overheating, some experts say it's important to pay attention not only to the

heat index but to a lesser-known measure: the “wet bulb globe temperature.”

Wet-bulb temperature incorporates such factors as humidity, cloud cover, and wind to measure the effect of heat on the body's ability to cool down. The more moisture there is in the air, the slower a person's

sweat evaporates, and when sweat leaves the skin, it takes heat with it.

“Wet bulb is really what a human being experiences,” said Dr. N. Stuart Harris, an emergency medicine physician at Mass General Brigham.

With a heat wave set to drive temperatures into triple digits and send humidity climbing, wet-bulb temperatures are expected to soar. Sweltering heat is expected to last from Wednesday until Friday, with temperatures subsiding a little on

Saturday and dropping back into the 80s on Sunday.

Dew points in the mid-70s combined with hot air can push the wet-bulb temperature toward dangerous levels because that's when sweat can stop evaporating. Some research suggests that a wet-bulb temperature of 95 degrees is the theoretical limit at which a person can no longer shed heat even when they're at rest. Other studies put the real-
HEAT, Page A7



PHOTOS BY STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF



FLIGHTS, FICKLE AND FANCIFUL

At left, one of the nearly 11,000 spectators chased bubbles dancing in the breeze as participants waited for conditions to improve at the 46th Annual Quechee Balloon Festival earlier this month. Finally, the poor weather relented and the hot-air balloons took to the heavens, including one that was reflected in the Ottauquechee River in southern Vermont. **As I See It, B1.**

Cambridge tackles new idea on affordability

Task force delves into ‘social housing,’ which reduces role of private investors

By **Spencer Buell**
GLOBE STAFF

In progressive circles, “social housing” is all the rage.

From Washington, D.C., to New York City, the concept has been part of winning candidates' platforms this election season. It's been

pitched as a way for the government to get more involved in building the kinds of homes that voters say they want. Specifically: lots of them, in the spots they want, at a price they can afford.

Social housing is now gaining traction in can't-believe-the-rent

Greater Boston, where frustration is building about the cost of living.

So how would social housing work in practice? What does it even mean? A group of more than a dozen elected leaders and housing experts in Cambridge is trying to get to the bottom of such questions so a pilot can get underway.

The basic idea behind social housing, proponents say, is to produce buildings that are subsidized

or even owned by the government, that are permanently affordable, and that accommodate people who are poor and those who have higher incomes under the same roof — all while taking profit-seeking investors largely, or entirely, out of the picture.

“Social housing is such an incredible opportunity for us to think about how we can work toward
HOUSING, Page A7

States get win over mail-in ballots

Court's rejection of GOP bid to end practice offers relief ahead of midterms

By **Julie Carr Smyth**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

States that allow mail ballots to be counted after Election Day reacted with relief Monday after the Supreme Court rejected a Republican effort to outlaw the practice.

A decision favoring the state of Mississippi over the Republican National Committee delivered an immediate reprieve to the 14 states — including Massachusetts — with grace periods for regular mail ballots, as well as heading off what was expected to be a scramble to alter the practice and inform voters just months ahead of the mid-term elections.

At least one state, Ohio, had preemptively changed its law in anticipation of a different result from the court, and 15 other states have such grace periods specifically for military and overseas voters.

Washington Secretary of State Steve Hobbs said the ruling means “the thousands of voters whose ballots are postmarked on time but received after Election Day still have their voices
COURT, Page A4

The power to fire

Justices cleared the way for president to oust independent regulators. **A4.**

Potential paths opened to avoid tick diseases

Research advances into vaccines, antibody shots

By **Allyson Chiu**
GLOBE STAFF
and **Emily Spatz**
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Amid the alarming rise in tick-borne diseases, particularly here in New England, researchers are working on promising approaches to better protect people while they spend time outdoors. Technologies under development include vaccines, injectable antibodies, and novel pills similar to common tick and flea treatments for pets.

A greater focus on preventing illnesses transmitted by ticks is long overdue, said Dr. Mark Klempner, a professor of medicine at UMass Chan Medical School, who researches Lyme disease, the most common tick-borne disease in the United States.

“That's the whole story in American medicine,” Klempner said. “We spend so much time taking care of the sick. If we would pay a little more attention to prevention, we would save ourselves money and sorrow.”

More than 470,000 Americans contract Lyme disease — spread by bacteria from the bites of in-
LYME, Page A10



Fort knocks

Tuesday: Warm, storm late. High 84-89, low 69-74.

Wednesday: Hot, stray storm. High 93-98, low 76-81.

Sunrise: 5:11. Sunset: 8:25.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Alvin Campbell Jr. was sentenced to life in prison for a series of sexual assaults committed as he posed as an Uber driver. **B1.**

Massachusetts legislative leaders reached a deal on a budget for the fiscal year, which begins Wednesday. **B1.**

The United States and Iran differed on the next steps for peace negotiations after the two nations exchanged attacks. **A3.**

About 140,000 Massachusetts residents will have some or all of their medical debt erased under the state's single-largest debt relief program to date. **D1.**

In a stunning World Cup upset in Foxborough, Paraguay defeats Germany on penalty kicks. **C1.**

Three dead after car plunges into R.I. river

By **Steph Machado**
GLOBE STAFF

PAWTUCKET, R.I. — Josue Gomez said he received a frantic call from his wife Sunday night.

She was out teaching their daughter how to drive, Gomez told the Globe in Spanish on Monday. Their 2-year-old granddaughter was also in the car. On the phone, she told her husband something was wrong.

“It won't brake, it won't brake,” Gomez said his wife was shouting.

“It was the last thing she said to me,” he said.

He raced down to the boat ramp on Taft Street near their Pawtucket apartment complex, he said. But the car was already underwater.

Pawtucket police said in a statement the three generations of the family were found dead in the car on Monday in what they described as a “tragic accident,” with no signs of foul play. Police pulled the car from the Seekonk River on Monday afternoon and towed it away as dozens of family members, friends, and neighbors looked on.

Police identified the victims as 45, 22, and 2-
SUBMERGED, Page A10



STEPH MACHADO/GLOBE STAFF

A car was pulled from the Seekonk River Monday in Pawtucket, R.I.